

TKT-2026-0716-268 - Order API timeouts and 503 errors during flash sale

Support Ticket | Support

Document ID	TKT-2026-0716-268	Seller ID	S002
Department	Support	Classification	CONFIDENTIAL
Owner	Rahul Sharma	Created Date	2026-07-16
Related Scenario ID	SC-003	Document Type	Support Ticket

Ticket Header

Field	Value
Ticket ID	TKT-2026-0716-268
Seller	S002 - BluePeak Electronics
Raised by	Sameer Khanna
Channel	Phone, during live event
Raised at	2026-07-16 20:07 IST
Priority	P1 - Critical (live revenue event failing)
Category	API availability and performance
Assigned to	Rahul Sharma, Support
Escalated to	Vikram Singh, Engineering
Closed at	2026-07-18 12:30 IST
Final status	Resolved - remediation deployed, orders replayed

Report

Sameer called at 20:07 IST, seven minutes into a flash sale that BluePeak had promoted with external paid media. Order placement calls were timing out and returning HTTP 503. He was watching his own dashboard and reported that roughly one in three placements was failing.

There was no ambiguity about impact or urgency. The sale had a fixed window, the marketing spend was already committed, and every failed placement was a lost order rather than a deferred one.

Support Actions During the Event

- I did three things in the first five minutes.
- Confirmed the failure from platform metrics: order API p99 latency was 11.8 seconds and rising, error rate 31 percent.
 - Escalated to Engineering on the incident channel at 20:12, five minutes after the call.
 - Asked Sameer one question that turned out to matter: what does your client

do when a call times out? His answer was that it retries until it succeeds.

That answer went straight into the escalation note. A client that retries without limit during a capacity event makes the capacity event worse.

Timeline

Time (IST)	Event
20:00	Flash sale begins
20:04	Order API latency begins rising
20:07	Seller calls Support
20:12	Escalated to Engineering, INC-2026-0716 opened
20:19	Connection pool exhaustion identified
20:26	Emergency pool increase applied
20:31	Rate limiting applied to the highest-volume client
20:44	Error rate falls below 2 percent
21:05	Latency returns to normal, sale continues
22:00	Sale ends
17 Jul 11:00	Post-incident call with seller
18 Jul 09:40	Failed orders replayed where carts were still valid
18 Jul 12:30	Ticket closed

Impact

Measure	Value
Peak p99 latency	12.4 seconds
Failed order placements	3,900
Duration of significant degradation	approximately 40 minutes
Orders recovered by replay	1,120
Net lost orders	approximately 2,780

Cause

An unbounded client retry policy generated a retry storm. Combined with a missing circuit breaker on the inventory lookup path, the order service connection pool was exhausted: healthy requests could not obtain a connection because the pool was full of retries waiting on a slow dependency.

The platform contributed the missing circuit breaker and an inadequate pool configuration. The client contributed the unbounded retries. Neither side alone would have produced a 40-minute degradation.

Post-Incident Discussion

The 17 July call was direct. Sameer's initial position was that the platform had failed to handle his traffic. Engineering's position was that the traffic had been amplified by his retry policy and that no capacity figure would have been sufficient against an unbounded retry loop.

Both were right, and the call ended with a shared workstream rather than an argument about blame:

- Platform: circuit breaker, pool resizing, request timeouts, and a change from HTTP 503 to HTTP 429 with Retry-After so correct client behaviour is explicit.

- BluePeak: bounded retries with exponential backoff and jitter, honour

Retry-After, add a client-side circuit breaker.

- Both: a 10-working-day capacity notice before any promotional event, which is now a contractual expectation on this account.

Resolution

Emergency mitigation restored service within 37 minutes of the seller's call. 1,120 failed orders were replayed on 18 July where the cart was still valid. Permanent remediation is tracked in the S002 throughput and resilience programme and was verified by a synthetic retry storm at four times observed peak on 24 August 2026.